

MIRCEA-PAVEL ANTON

Senior Platform Engineer | Kubernetes · GitOps · Cloud Infrastructure · ML/AI Platforms Bucharest, Romania
mircea@mirceanton.com · mirceanton.com · github.com/mirceanton · linkedin.com/in/mirceanton · youtube.com/@mirceanton

SUMMARY

Platform engineer who builds internal platforms that largely run themselves. At Raiffeisen Bank I lead the 4-person team behind **75+ production applications on 5 Kubernetes clusters** (both on-prem and AWS EKS) and **200+ repositories**, in a regulated, air-gapped environment, by treating the entire software supply chain (repo creation, scaffolding, deployment, promotion, and updates) as GitOps-managed automation. **CNCF Kubestronaut**, CloudNativeDays Romania speaker, and maintainer of open-source Kubernetes tooling, including an ExternalDNS provider listed upstream. I also share this work publicly through a YouTube channel and blog on CloudNative technologies as I apply them in my Homelab.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Raiffeisen Bank Bucharest, Romania

Lead MLOps Engineer (platform engineering for ML & AI workloads)

Jun 2024 – Present

- **Platform ownership at scale:** Lead a team of 4 engineers operating the platform behind 75+ production applications (fraud detection, churn prediction, ATM cash forecasting, internal and client-facing AI assistants) across 2 on-prem K3s and 3 AWS EKS clusters. Trained team members from no prior Kubernetes experience to owning the platform independently.
- **Internal Developer Platform:** Designed the path from “I need a repo” to “running in production and keeping itself updated” as one automated supply chain. Developers self-serve repos, deployments, and promotions and own their app lifecycle end to end; release cadence went from monthly to multiple times per day.
- **Self-updating golden paths:** Built a composable Copier template stack (base, Python backend, frontend, Flux deploy) with a standard CI contract, CodeQL and security scanning, and automated SemVer/CalVer releases. Renovate runs copier update downstream, so a template release reaches every repository as a PR within ~30 minutes and typically merges within an hour.
- **GitHub as code:** Manage all 200+ repositories (branch protection, team access, required checks) through OpenTofu and Terragrunt, reconciled on a schedule to prevent drift. Wrapped it in Copier and Taskfile so anyone can create a compliant repo with a single command.
- **GitOps fleet and promotion:** Architected the FluxCD fleet repository for an air-gapped environment, with template-driven tenant onboarding, per-cluster post-build substitution, and flux-local validation in CI. Branch-based PRELIVE → LIVE promotion runs through a service-account-only workflow, producing a clean audit trail for banking controls.
- **Infrastructure in the same loop:** Brought non-Kubernetes dependencies (Keycloak clients, LiteLLM tenants, S3 buckets, IAM roles) under GitOps without the need of Flux Tofu Controller, thanks to 3rd party Kubernetes Operators, making sure that infrastructure is deployed and versioned alongside each application’s manifests in a single wave.
- **Dependency automation:** Standardized shared Renovate presets covering container images, OCI Helm charts, Flux, OpenTofu providers and modules, GitHub Actions, Python/Node packages, and Kubernetes apiVersions. Trusted patch/minor updates auto-merge on green CI, with no human in the loop.
- **On-prem platform:** Designed and built the on-prem Kubernetes platform from scratch on a 10-node cluster based on K3S running on top of CentOS. Deployed and configured critical cluster services such as Cillium, Envoy Gateway, CertManager, TrustManager and various other
- **Hybrid cloud:** Moved production applications to EKS and GPU workloads to SageMaker, keeping on-prem capacity for batch processing, compute-heavy jobs and internal services.
- **Resilience:** Designed a disaster recovery solution that restored the entire platform, infrastructure and applications, in ~8 hours after critical hardware failure.
- **Platform services:** Built an event-driven usage-analytics pipeline for the bank’s AI application suite with an accompanying internal Python SDK to facilitate adoption from developers

MLOps Engineer

Sep 2023 – Jun 2024

- Led the move from manual deployments to GitOps with FluxCD, establishing a repeatable, auditable deployment model.
- Provisioned infrastructure with Terraform and brought it into the same GitOps workflow as applications via the Flux Tofu Controller.
- Built CI/CD from the ground up on GitHub Actions, adding automated linting, testing, and Renovate-driven dependency maintenance using both off-the-shelf and custom-built TypeScript actions
- Deployed Keycloak as an Identity Provider federated by our internal Active Directory server for identity management; OAuth2 Proxy as a generic OAuth2 layer for authentication, and MinIO for object-storage services
- Collaborated with application teams to refactor workloads to follow 12-factor standard and be Kubernetes/Cloud ready.

Thales

DevOps Engineer

Jul 2021 – Jul 2023

- Developed and operated a Kubernetes-based Internal Developer Platform for engineering teams, integrating GitLab, Jenkins, Artifactory, Nexus, Keycloak, SonarQube, Dependency-Track, DefectDojo, and midPoint.
- Built Jenkins pipelines for automated testing and deployment, and Ansible automation for repeatable service configuration.
- Provisioned Kubernetes development environments on AWS with Terraform, and automated identity and access management workflows around midPoint.

SPEAKING & COMMUNITY

- **Speaker, CloudNativeDays Romania 2026:** “GitOps in the Wild: How we run FluxCD at Raiffeisen Bank”, a case study on running 75+ apps with a 4-person team.
- **Workshop lead, OmniOpenCon 2025:** “From Zero to Website in 100 Minutes”, a hands-on session for students, teaching them about automated static site deployments with Hugo, GitHub Codespaces, GitHub Actions, and GitHub Pages.
- **Guest, KubeFM podcast (2024):** “The best operating system for Kubernetes”, on choosing Talos Linux as a minimal and immutable API-driven Operating System for Kubernetes.
- **Creator, YouTube & blog:** videos and long-form posts on CloudNative topics such as Kubernetes, Talos Linux, GitOps, Ceph, backup and storage, and infrastructure as code, built on a public, production-style homelab.

OPEN SOURCE WORK

- **external-dns-provider-mikrotik** (Go): ExternalDNS webhook provider for MikroTik RouterOS, listed as supported in upstream kubernetes-sigs/external-dns. Lead maintainer of a community project with **7 contributors** and **389K+ container image pulls**.
- **home-ops:** GitOps monorepo for a Talos Linux cluster with FluxCD, Cilium, Envoy Gateway, CloudNativePG, VolSync, Keycloak, LDAP, Prometheus/Grafana/AlertManager, and self-hosted LLM inference to name a few. Securely accessed remotely through WireGuard VPN, both road warrior and Site-to-Site configurations. Currently serving actual applications to 10 users.
- **mikrotik-terraform:** an entire MikroTik network managed as code with Terraform and Terragrunt, using a modular layout via custom OpenTofu modules and secure state management through encrypted S3 state.
- **Kubernetes & Talos CLIs:** **kubectl-switch**, **talswitcher**, and **talstomize** (Go), distributed via Homebrew tap, container images, and cross-platform binaries.
- **CI/CD building blocks:** reusable GitHub Actions for CalVer releases, Conventional Commit SemVer metadata, and dynamic monorepo job matrices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Kubestronaut:** CNCF, 2024
 - **Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA):** CNCF, 2022
 - **Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD):** CNCF, 2022
 - **Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS):** CNCF, 2022
 - **Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate (KCNA):** CNCF, 2024
 - **Kubernetes and Cloud Native Security Associate (KCSA):** CNCF, 2024
- **Certified GitOps Associate (CGOA):** CNCF, 2024
- **Linux Foundation Certified System Administrator (LFCS):** 2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Kubernetes & GitOps: Kubernetes, AWS EKS, K3s, Talos Linux, FluxCD, Helm, Kustomize, Cilium, Envoy Gateway / Gateway API, NGINX Ingress, ExternalDNS

Infrastructure as Code: OpenTofu / Terraform, Terragrunt, FluxCD Tofu Controller, Ansible, Copier

Cloud & Storage: AWS (EKS, IAM, S3, SageMaker), Rook/Ceph, MinIO, Garage, CloudNativePG, VolSync

CI/CD & Supply Chain: GitHub Actions, Renovate, CodeQL, Artifactory (OCI), Jenkins, GitLab CI, Taskfile, Conventional Commits

Security & Identity: Keycloak, OAuth2 Proxy, LDAP, cert-manager, trust-manager, SOPS/age, vulnerability scanning

Data, Messaging & Observability: PostgreSQL, RabbitMQ, Dragonfly (Redis), Prometheus, Grafana, AlertManager

AI/ML Infrastructure: AWS SageMaker, LiteLLM, Airflow, MLFlow, on-prem LLM inference on Kubernetes through vLLM/llama.cpp via LLMKube

Languages & Systems: Go, Python, Bash, JavaScript/TypeScript, Linux, MikroTik RouterOS

EDUCATION

MSc, Digital Management | POLITEHNICA University of Bucharest, Faculty of Entrepreneurship, Business Engineering & Mgmt.

BSc, Systems Engineering | POLITEHNICA University of Bucharest, Faculty of Automatic Control and Computers